

ARCH 320: History of Architecture and Urban Morphologies

Term: Fall 2026 | Instructor: Prof. Le Corbusier (lcorbusier@arch.univ.edu)

Course Description & Overview:

A global critical survey of spatial design, tectonic systems, urban fabrics, and social theory from antiquity to parametric contemporary cities.

COURSE ASSIGNMENTS & WEIGHT DISTRIBUTION

Assignment Description	Weight	Due Module	Deliverable Format
Vernacular Architecture Field Analysis	20%	Week 04	Illustrated Monograph
Comparative Urban Morphology Essay	30%	Week 08	Spatial Mapping & Essay
Studio Design Portfolio Capstone	40%	Week 12	Archival Quality Portfolio
Sketchbook Submissions	10%	Continuous	Weekly Architectural Sketches

WEEKLY TERM SCHEDULE & READING REQUIREMENTS

Timeline	Technical Topic Focus	Assigned Readings & Docs
Week 01	Module 01: Classical Orders & Vitruvian Principles	Vitruvius (Ch. 1–3)
Week 02	Module 02: Roman Vaulting & Concrete Engineering	Ward-Perkins (Ch. 2–4)
Week 03	Module 03: Gothic Structural Logic & Flying Buttresses	Panofsky (1951)
Week 04	Module 04: Renaissance Proportion and Perspective	Wittkower (Ch. 1 & 2)
Week 05	Module 05: Baroque Urban Spaces & Plaza Dynamics	Kostof (Ch. 18)
Week 06	Module 06: Industrial Revolution & Iron Architecture	Frampton (Ch. 1–3)
Week 07	Module 07: Bauhaus & Modernist Functionalism	Gropius (1935); Curtis (Ch. 8)
Week 08	Module 08: Le Corbusier and Five Points of Architecture	Le Corbusier (1923)
Week 09	Module 09: Postmodernism and Venturi Irony	Venturi (1966)
Week 10	Module 10: Deconstructivism & Parametric Urbanism	Eisenman (1988); Schumacher (Ch. 2)
Week 11	Module 11: Sustainable Biophilic Architecture	LEED Guidelines; Kellert (2005)
Week 12	Module 12: Final Design Review & Exhibition	Studio Critique Specs